



Activity File: Creating Group Policy with Group Policy Objects

In this activity, you will continue your role as a Windows system administrator managing Active Directory for Good Corp, Inc.

- You need to create Group Policy Objects (GPOs) to enforce policies for users.
- You are tasked with creating a Group Policy Object for the **Sales** OU that will limit the options they have to Windows **Settings**.

Make sure you are using your nested **Windows Server machine** for this activity.

If you followed along with the demo, you need to unlink the **No Control Panel** panel from the **Sales** OU as it may interfere with your activity.

Instructions

1. Create the GPO. Navigate to the **Group Policy Management** tool.
 - The **Group Policy Management** tool is similar to the **Active Directory Users and Computers** tool.
 - If you don't see the **Sales** OU, expand the folders under the **GOODCORP.NET** domain.
2. Name the GPO **Limit Settings**.
3. Right-click the GPO to **Edit...** its policies.
 - Find the policy you need under **User Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > Control Panel**. The policy you're looking for is called **Settings Page Visibility**. This policy is **not** in a subfolder in **Control Panel**.

- Set the policy to **Enabled**.
 - Under **Settings Page Visibility**, enter **showonly:about;themes**.
 - Apply and accept these changes.
4. After you have enabled the policy, link the GPO to the **Sales** OU.
5. Add the Sales group to the Remote Desktop Users group, if you haven't already.
- Open the **Active Directory Users and Computers** menu.
 - Expand your **GC Users** organizational unit.
 - Select the **Sales** sub-organizational unit. The **Sales group** will appear in the right-side pane.
 - Right-click that **Sales** group and select **Add to a group....**
 - Under the **Enter the object names to select** area, enter **Remote** and click **Check Names**.
 - Click the **Remote Desktop Users** and click **OK**.
 - Click **OK** again.
6. Refresh these policy and group changes on the Windows 10 machine.
- Open a **PowerShell** or CMD window and enter:

- **gpupdate**

After a few seconds, you should see the message

Updating policy...

Computer Policy update has completed successfully

User Policy update has completed successfully.

This means the machine has now pulled the latest group policies.

Switch over to the user BOB on the WIN10 machine

- Now you can select the Windows Start Menu icon, then select the user sysadmin, and then switch user option to login as Bob.
 - Take a quick moment to look at the default **Windows Settings**.
 - Click the **Start** menu, then click the cogwheel icon to launch the **Settings** menu.
 - You don't have to do anything here, but notice the limited settings.
7. Test the Group Policy changes as **Bob**. Verify that Bob's account has limited access to **Windows Settings** by doing the following:
- Click the **Windows** button in the bottom-left and then click the **Settings** icon.
 - If you created the GPO properly, you should only see two entries there: **System** and **Personalization**.
 - This indicates that the Group Policy Object was successfully applied. The standard **Windows Settings** screen has many more options.
 - Know that system administrators will often restrict access to various operating system settings to prevent users from making irreversible or potentially dangerous changes to their system.